

Re-watch

A VERY LONG TIME AGO, JULY 1995 TO BE MORE PRECISE, I GOT MY FIRST EVER “EXPENSIVE” BIRTHDAY PRESENT FROM A FRIEND OF MY FATHER. It was a designer watch, limited series from perfume and tobacco product giant Davidoff. I can't even find photos of the watch on the internet, that's how old it is, and possibly also a measure of the watch's limited popularity.

I'd owned watches before, of course, but usually the cheapest of the cheap ones, which wouldn't even last a year. This one I was super-thrilled by, despite not really liking the feel of a watch. It had a rotating bezel/dial, something my simplistic watches before this had never had, not that I had much use for the feature. It felt heavy on my wrist, the brushed silver look was not blingy, (I hate blingy things). It was perfect.

Four or five days after my birthday, I was walking out of a friend's house, and he had a grill gate. Somehow my watch got stuck between the grill, and long story short, I broke my precious watch, and it was unfixable locally since it came from the UK.

To add injury to insult, as most 80s/90s Indian kids know only too well, the real punishment happens when you get home because our parents were all, let's say, avid believers in the merits of using corporal punishment to discipline us. Boy did I get a sore spot or twenty for being so careless. That's the last watch I ever owned. Until now.

I'm pretty sure everyone else in Team Digit has had a fair bit of experience with smartwatches and fitness trackers, and here I am, the old fogey who hasn't worn anything on his wrists for the past 27 years. Even my wife and mother-in-law were early adopters of the Apple Watch, and have kept telling me to get one. There are only so many times you can hear the phrase, “Come on, you work for the biggest tech media brand in India and you have never had a smartwatch”. So I finally took the plunge.

I bought the new Samsung Galaxy Watch5 Pro because I'm an Android user, and Apple still stubbornly refuses to allow its devices to work cross platform... but that's a rant for another time. Honestly, I don't even know what to expect of it. For starters I hope it lasts me more than 5 days (or more than 5 months for that matter!), or else it will certainly be the last watch I ever buy!

I do have experience with Apple's watches, because I had to set them up for the family members who own them, and had to read up about them before buying them. Plus, I have more than enough experts in Team Digit to help out. I'm told that I will like the new watch from Samsung, because it is touted to be a huge improvement over the last one, with some opinions going as far as saying it might finally bridge the gap between itself and the Apple Watch. So yes, I'm an early adopter of the new model, but I'm told I took a pretty safe gamble.

However, you know how excited people (including me) get when they get a new gadget? They rush to open it – absolutely love the ripping open of the plastic packaging, and live for the final reveal when you pull it out of the box. As I write this, it's been over 12 hours since it was delivered, and I still haven't touched the box.

Part of me is still thinking maybe I should just return it, it's not cheap for starters, and I could get another SSD to add on even more storage to my PC. Or just save the money towards the PC upgrade cycle that I will soon want to begin – as soon as the next gen GPUs are released, probably.

Then again, it also bugs me that there's this entire aspect of tech that I have totally missed out on, all because of a weird quirk I developed after breaking something I really liked. I'll probably open the packaging soon and take the plunge.

Not only will I take the plunge, but I'm diving in at the deep end. I'm going to review the Samsung Galaxy Watch5 Pro using our full test process, which will take care of the objective tests. However I will also write about my experience from the perspective of a total n00b. I'll publish the results on digit.in and in next month's mag. So, if you're interested in reading about how I fumble my way through using my first watch in nearly 30 years then watch this space.

PS: I also wanted to thank all of you, and the millions of others who visit us on digit.in. Thanks to your hunger to know more about tech, digit.in was the most visited technology site in the country on a mobile, as per the premier traffic ranking service Comscore, for the month of July 2022. (Source: Comscore Mobile Metrix July 2022). Yay! 🎉



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